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Wine

9.1 Wine

References:

Hebrew חֶמֶר (chemer) DEU 32:14, ISA 27:2

Aramaic חֲמַר (chamar) EZR 6:9, EZR 7:22, DAN 5:1, DAN 5:2, DAN 5:4, DAN 5:23

Hebrew יַיִן (yayin) GEN 9:21, GEN 9:24, GEN 14:18, GEN 19:32, GEN 19:33, GEN 19:34, GEN 19:35, GEN 27:25, GEN 49:11, GEN 49:12, EXO 29:40, LEV 10:9, LEV 23:13, NUM 6:3, NUM 6:3, NUM 6:4, NUM 6:20, NUM 15:5, NUM 15:7, NUM 15:10, NUM 28:14, DEU 14:26, DEU 28:39, DEU 29:5, DEU 32:33, DEU 32:38, JOS 9:4, JOS 9:13, JDG 13:4, JDG 13:7, JDG 13:14, JDG 13:14, JDG 19:19, 1SA 1:14, 1SA 1:15, 1SA 1:24, 1SA 10:3, 1SA 16:20, 1SA 25:18, 1SA 25:37, 2SA 13:28, 2SA 16:1, 2SA 16:2, 1CH 9:29, 1CH 12:41, 1CH 27:27, 2CH 2:9, 2CH 2:14, 2CH 11:11, NEH 2:1, NEH 2:1, NEH 5:15, NEH 5:18, NEH 13:15, EST 1:7, EST 1:10, EST 5:6, EST 7:2, EST 7:7, EST 7:8, JOB 1:13, JOB 1:18, JOB 32:19, PSA 60:5, PSA 75:9, PSA 78:65, PSA 104:15, PRO 4:17, PRO 9:2, PRO 9:5, PRO 20:1, PRO 21:17, PRO 23:20, PRO 23:30, PRO 23:31, PRO 31:4, PRO 31:6, ECC 2:3, ECC 9:7, ECC 10:19, SNG 1:2, SNG 1:4, SNG 2:4, SNG 4:10, SNG 5:1, SNG 7:10, SNG 8:2, ISA 5:11, ISA 5:12, ISA 5:22, ISA 16:10, ISA 22:13, ISA 24:9, ISA 24:11, ISA 28:1, ISA 28:7, ISA 28:7, ISA 29:9, ISA 51:21, ISA 55:1, ISA 56:12, JER 13:12, JER 13:12, JER 23:9, JER 25:15, JER 35:2, JER 35:5, JER 35:5, JER 35:6, JER 35:6, JER 35:8, JER 35:14, JER 40:10, JER 40:12, JER 48:33, JER 51:7, LAM 2:12, EZK 27:18, EZK 44:21, DAN 1:5, DAN 1:8, DAN 1:16, DAN 10:3, HOS 4:11, HOS 7:5, HOS 9:4, HOS 14:8, JOL 1:5, JOL 4:3, AMO 2:8, AMO 2:12, AMO 5:11, AMO 6:6, AMO 9:14, MIC 2:11, MIC 6:15, HAB 2:5, ZEP 1:13, HAG 2:12, ZEC 9:15, ZEC 10:7

Hebrew מֶזֶג (mezeg) SNG 7:3

Hebrew מִמְסָךְ (mimsak) PRO 23:30, ISA 65:11

Hebrew מֶסֶךְ (mesek) PSA 75:9

Hebrew נֶסֶךְ (nesek) GEN 35:14, EXO 29:40, EXO 29:41, EXO 30:9, LEV 23:13, LEV 23:18, LEV 23:37, NUM 4:7, NUM 6:15, NUM 6:17, NUM 15:5, NUM 15:7, NUM 15:10, NUM 15:24, NUM 28:7, NUM 28:7, NUM 28:8, NUM 28:9, NUM 28:10, NUM 28:14, NUM 28:15, NUM 28:24, NUM 28:31, NUM 29:6, NUM 29:11, NUM 29:16, NUM 29:18, NUM 29:19, NUM 29:21, NUM 29:22, NUM 29:24, NUM 29:25, NUM 29:27, NUM 29:28, NUM 29:30, NUM 29:31, NUM 29:33, NUM 29:34, NUM 29:37, NUM 29:38, NUM 29:39, 2KI 16:13, 2KI 16:15, 1CH 29:21, 2CH 29:35, PSA 16:4, ISA 57:6, JER 7:18, JER 19:13, JER 32:29, JER 44:17, JER 44:18, JER 44:19, JER 44:19, JER 44:25, EZK 20:28, EZK 45:17, JOL 1:9, JOL 1:13, JOL 2:14

Hebrew שֶׁמֶר (shemer) PSA 75:9, ISA 25:6, ISA 25:6, JER 48:11, ZEP 1:12

Greek οἶνος (oinos) MAT 9:17, MAT 9:17, MAT 9:17, MAT 27:34, MRK 2:22, MRK 2:22, MRK 2:22, MRK 2:22, MRK 15:23, LUK 1:15, LUK 5:37, LUK 5:37, LUK 5:38, LUK 7:33, LUK 10:34, JHN 2:3, JHN 2:3, JHN 2:9, JHN 2:10, JHN 2:10, JHN 4:46, ROM 14:21, EPH 5:18, 1TI 3:8, 1TI 5:23, TIT 2:3, REV 6:6, REV 14:8, REV 14:10, REV 16:19, REV 17:2, REV 18:3, REV 18:13, REV 19:15, TOB 4:15, JDT 10:5, JDT 11:13, JDT 12:1, JDT 12:13, JDT 12:20, JDT 13:2, ESG 1:7, ESG 4:17, WIS 2:7, SIR 9:9, SIR 19:2, SIR 31:25, SIR 31:25, SIR 31:26, SIR 31:27, SIR 31:27, SIR 31:28, SIR 31:29, SIR 31:31, SIR 32:5, SIR 32:6, SIR 40:20, SIR 49:1, BEL 1:11, BEL 1:15, BEL 1:21, BEL 1:33, 2MA 15:39, 2MA 15:39, 3MA 5:2, 3MA 5:10, 3MA 5:45, 3MA 6:30, 1ES 3:10, 1ES 3:17, 1ES 3:18, 1ES 3:23, 1ES 3:24, 1ES 4:14, 1ES 4:16, 1ES 4:37, 1ES 6:29, 1ES 8:20, ODA 2:14, ODA 2:33, ODA 2:38, PSS 8:14

Latin vinum 2ES 9:24

Description:

Wine was a fermented drink made from the juice of grapes. The grape harvest season began in the land of Israel around the start of July and went on through the summer. The process of extracting the juice (see 1.1.10 Wine press<REALIA:1.1.10>) and fermentation meant that the first wine (the “new wine”) was available in September. Fully fermented wine could be stored for several years, although not as long as is possible today with modern methods of pasteurization and storage. It was common practice to dilute wine with water before drinking it (as much as 50 percent or more). Similarly, wine could also be sweetened with some agent such as honey.

Translation:

Some people have argued that whenever mention is made of Jesus either making or drinking wine, we must assume that this was only unfermented grape juice. There is no real basis for such a conclusion. Only where "new wine" is mentioned can we assume that this is unfermented grape juice or grape juice in the initial stages of fermentation (see 9.1.1 New wine<REALIA:9.1.1>).

In a number of languages there is no indigenous term for "wine," and some expression may simply be borrowed from a dominant language. On the other hand, it is sometimes possible to use a descriptive phrase, for example, "fermented fruit juice." In some languages the equivalent for "wine" is more specifically "palm wine," which is a wine made from the sap of certain palm trees. Such a term may also have a more generic meaning and may be applicable to any kind of wine. The term used must be an alcoholic drink (not, for example, simply "grape juice"), otherwise references to its intoxicating power will not make sense.

ISA 27:2: The Hebrew text contains the word chemer, meaning "wine." However, there has probably been a corruption in the final letter of the word, making the proper reading "pleasant" or "delightful."

GEN 9:24; 1SA 1:14; 1SA 25:37: Some translators render the Hebrew word yayin in these verses as "drunkenness."

The Hebrew words mezeg and mesek indicate a mixture and probably refer to wine that was diluted with water. In SNG 7:3 some interpreters and translators understand the meaning to be "spiced wine" (GNT, GW). Other translations are "mixed wine" (NRSV) and "blended wine" (NIV).

The Hebrew word nesek literally indicates a liquid poured out. In practice, it was the pouring out of wine as an offering to God or other gods. It will sometimes be possible to translate it simply "wine." Usually, however, something like "drink offering" is to be preferred.

When juice was pressed from grapes, a certain amount of small solids escaped the filtering process. When the juice stood in containers to ferment into wine, these solids (called in English "dregs" or "lees") sank to the bottom and even aided in the fermentation process, adding to the quality of the wine. They could be filtered out of the wine before it was served. The Hebrew word for these settled solids is shemer. Depending on the context, it can symbolize the quality of the wine (ISA 25:6), the fact that the wine had not yet been disturbed (JER 48:11; ZEP 1:12), or simply what remains at the very bottom of the container (PSA 75:9). Common-language translations, especially in those places where winemaking is unfamiliar, avoid a literal rendering of shemer. Here are the renderings of GNT for the four appearances of shemer: "to the last drop" (PSA 75:9), "the finest wine" (ISA 25:6), "like wine left to settle undisturbed" (JER 48:11), and "who are self-satisfied and confident" (ZEP 1:12).

There are a number of passages in the New Testament where translators must be particularly careful in the selection of terms to render "wine"; for example, in EPH 5:18 a literal translation of "do not get drunk with wine" (RSV) could be interpreted to mean that it is permissible for people to get drunk on other types of intoxicating drinks. Therefore it may be necessary in some languages to render this clause simply as "do not get drunk."

In LUK 10:34 the second and third clauses are literally "he bandaged his wounds, pouring olive oil and wine over [them]." Here it is important to recognize the medicinal value of oil and wine. In some languages translators have indicated the purpose of such an activity by saying "to cleanse and heal his wounds, he poured wine and oil on them and bandaged them." It may also be helpful to add a footnote about the antiseptic quality of the wine and the value of the oil in the healing process.

New wine

9.1.1 New wine

References:

Hebrew עָסִיס (ʿasis) SNG 8:2, ISA 49:26, JOL 1:5, JOL 4:18, AMO 9:13

Hebrew תִּירוֹשׁ (tirosh) GEN 27:28, GEN 27:37, NUM 18:12, DEU 7:13, DEU 11:14, DEU 12:17, DEU 14:23, DEU 18:4, DEU 28:51, DEU 33:28, JDG 9:13, 2KI 18:32, 2CH 31:5, 2CH 32:28, NEH 5:11, NEH 10:38, NEH 10:40, NEH 13:5, NEH 13:12, PSA 4:8,

PRO 3:10, ISA 24:7, ISA 36:17, ISA 62:8, ISA 65:8, JER 31:12, HOS 2:10, HOS 2:11, HOS 2:24, HOS 4:11, HOS 7:14, HOS 9:2, JOL 1:10, JOL 2:19, JOL 2:24, MIC 6:15, HAG 1:11, ZEC 9:17

Greek οἶνος, νέος (oinos neos) MAT 9:17, MAT 9:17, MRK 2:22, MRK 2:22, LUK 5:37, LUK 5:37, LUK 5:38, SIR 9:10

Description:

New wine was newly pressed grape juice, unfermented or in the initial stages of fermentation.

Translation:

While the Hebrew words ‘asis and tirosh may refer to unfermented juice, they sometimes indicate wine in the first stages of fermentation. Some languages, especially in wine-growing areas, have a special word for this drink, which is available for only a short time after the grape harvest. The context may indicate if the beverage intended is fermented or not. Where it is determined that fermented juice is spoken of, translators may simply render ‘asis or tirosh as “wine,” which GNT does in the middle of JDG 9:13: “I would have to stop producing my wine.”

Sweet wine

9.1.2 Sweet wine

References:

Hebrew מַמְתַּקִּים (mamthaqim) NEH 8:10

Greek γλεῦκος (gleukos) ACT 2:13

Description:

Sweet wine was wine (see 9.1 Wine<REALIA:9.1>) to which a sweetening agent, such as honey, had been added.

Translation:

NEH 8:10: Nehemiah orders the people to “eat choice foods and drink sweet drinks” (NJPSV). The “sweet drinks” are understood by the Vulgate to be wine sweetened with honey, which is likely (RSV “sweet wine”). Like NJPSV, many other translations have simply “sweet drinks” without specifying the type (NIV, REB).

ACT 2:13: In classical Greek the word gleukos could designate new wine, that is, grape juice in the initial stages of fermentation (or even unfermented grape juice). For this reason some translations have rendered it “new wine” (RSV). However, the chronology of ACT 2:13 seems to eliminate this possibility. The events described in ACT 2:0 could not have happened later than the middle of the month of June. This is well before grapes are harvested, and therefore there could have been no fermenting juice. It would have to be from wine from a previous harvest. Those who accused the disciples of being drunk would have known this. While there were methods for keeping such wine sweet, it would not have been “new.” Therefore it seems best to translate gleukos here as “sweet wine” or even “sweetened wine.” It is possible, and in many languages preferable, to translate the last clause of this verse as “They have been drinking” (REB) or “These people are drunk” (GNT).

Vinegar

9.1.3 Vinegar

References:

Hebrew חֹמֶץ (chomets) NUM 6:3, NUM 6:3, RUT 2:14, PSA 69:22, PRO 10:26, PRO 25:20

Greek ὄξος (oxos) MAT 27:48, MRK 15:36, LUK 23:36, JHN 19:29, JHN 19:29, JHN 19:30

Description:

Vinegar was wine that had fermented to the point of becoming sour. It is supposed that this drink was produced by making the grape juice ferment artificially, for instance, by adding barley or some bacterial agent.

Translation:

Mixed with water, sour wine or wine vinegar was a popular drink among soldiers and workmen since it was cheaper than wine, and good for quenching thirst. Without water, it would be very strong and intoxicating, and could even cause unconsciousness.

“Sour wine” is sometimes rendered “bitter wine,” “sour juice,” or simply “sour drink.”